

## Facing difficulties

There is a little-known story about Kunti, told to us in our **ancient** books. Once, Krishn **granted** her a **boon** to ask for whatever she wanted. What she wanted was **strange**! She said to the Lord, 'Lord, give me a little **suffering** all the time, for I have come to realise that in **pleasures** and enjoyments, You are **often forgotten**. But in pain and suffering, You are always remembered.'

Kunti was right. Today, **many** of us **enjoy** the luxuries of life and **lead** comfortable lives. When everything goes right, we often forget God, feeling we can manage our lives perfectly well without His help. We may remember the Lord in passing, as we **mutter** a few prayers mechanically, but we are alright without Him. We **get on with our lives**. We are too busy, too involved, too **wrapped up** in our **worldly** activities to remember Him!



### THE SPEAKING TREE

But the moment things start going wrong, the moment difficulties **strike**, we turn to God with **alacrity**. We **call out** to Him to come to our aid. Such painful experiences are **essential** to our **spiritual** growth. God wants us to face them and grow in **moral** and spiritual strength. **The best way** to face such difficult situations **is** not **merely** to accept them, but to cooperate with their inner purpose, fixing our minds and hearts, not on the pain and difficulties we face but on Him who has planned it all for us.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

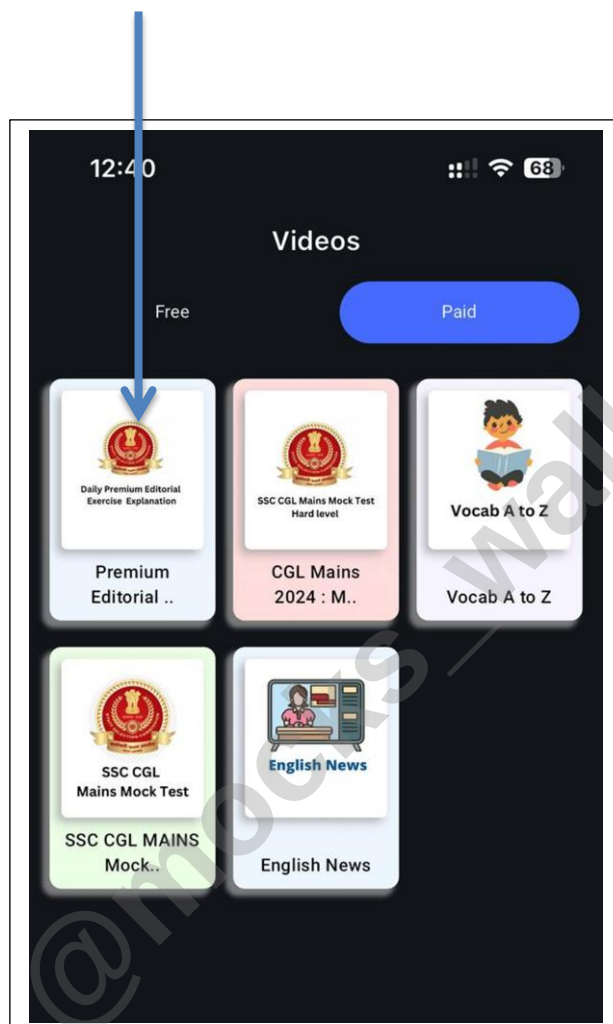
## Vocabulary

1. **Ancient** (adjective) – old, age-old, archaic, antique, prehistoric प्राचीन
2. **Grant** (verb) – bestow, confer, award, accord, permit प्रदान करना
3. **Boon** (noun) – blessing, benefit, gift, advantage, windfall वरदान
4. **Strange** (adjective) – odd, peculiar, unusual, bizarre, unfamiliar अजीब
5. **Suffering** (noun) – pain, distress, agony, torment, misery पीड़ा
6. **Pleasure** (noun) – joy, delight, happiness, gratification, enjoyment सुख
7. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, repeatedly, usually, commonly अक्सर
8. **Forgotten** (adjective) – overlooked, neglected, ignored, unremembered, disregarded भुलाया गया
9. **Mutter** (verb) – murmur, mumble, whisper, grumble, complain बड़बड़ाना
10. **Get on with our lives** (phrase) – continue, move ahead, proceed, resume, persist अपना जीवन आगे बढ़ाना
11. **Wrap up** (phrasal verb) – finish, conclude, complete, wind up, end समाप्त करना
12. **Worldly** (adjective) – materialistic, temporal, secular, mundane, earthly सांसारिक
13. **Strike** (verb) – hit, affect, attack, assail, befall आ पड़ना / टकराना
14. **Alacrity** (noun) – eagerness, willingness, enthusiasm, readiness, promptness उत्साह / तत्परता
15. **Call out** (phrasal verb) – shout, summon, cry out, appeal, exclaim पुकारना
16. **Essential** (adjective) – necessary, vital, crucial, fundamental, indispensable आवश्यक
17. **Spiritual** (adjective) – religious, sacred, divine, metaphysical, devotional आध्यात्मिक
18. **Moral** (adjective) – ethical, righteous, virtuous, upright, principled नैतिक
19. **Merely** (adverb) – only, simply, just, purely, solely केवल / मात्र

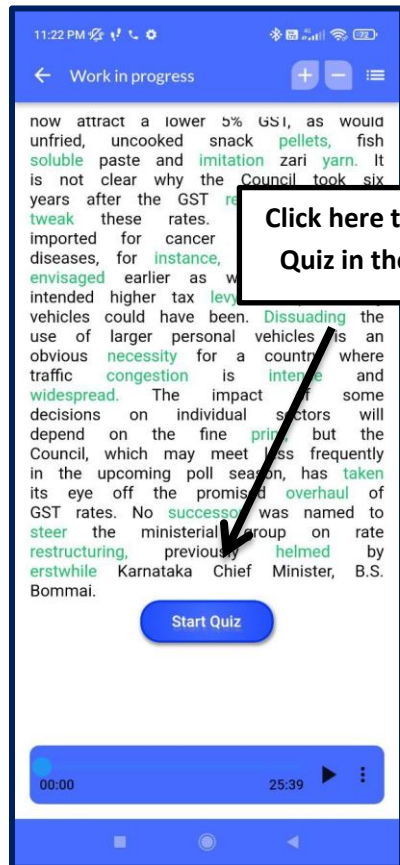
### Summary of the Editorial

1. **Kunti's Story Recalled** – The passage begins with a story from ancient texts where Kunti asks Krishna for constant suffering.
2. **Unusual Request** – Kunti's request was unusual: she wanted a little suffering always to stay connected to God.
3. **Insight in Suffering** – Her reasoning was that God is remembered more in suffering than in pleasure.
4. **Forgetting God in Comfort** – When life is easy and full of pleasures, people often forget God.
5. **Mechanical Prayers** – Even if remembered, prayers during good times are often mechanical and half-hearted.
6. **Self-sufficiency Illusion** – People feel independent and believe they can manage life without divine help.
7. **Spiritual Neglect** – Material comfort often leads to spiritual neglect and disconnection from the divine.
8. **Quick Turn to God in Pain** – When difficulties arise, people instantly turn to God for help.
9. **Suffering as a Catalyst** – Painful experiences trigger spiritual awakening and dependence on God.
10. **Purpose of Difficulties** – The passage suggests that God uses suffering to build moral and spiritual strength.
11. **Spiritual Growth through Pain** – Challenges are essential for one's inner and spiritual development.
12. **Cooperation, Not Just Acceptance** – We shouldn't just accept suffering passively but work with its deeper purpose.
13. **Focus on God, Not Pain** – The ideal response is to fix the heart and mind on God, not the suffering.
14. **Divine Planning** – All difficulties are portrayed as being part of God's greater plan for individual growth.
15. **Faith During Trials** – True spiritual progress involves remembering and trusting God especially during hardships.

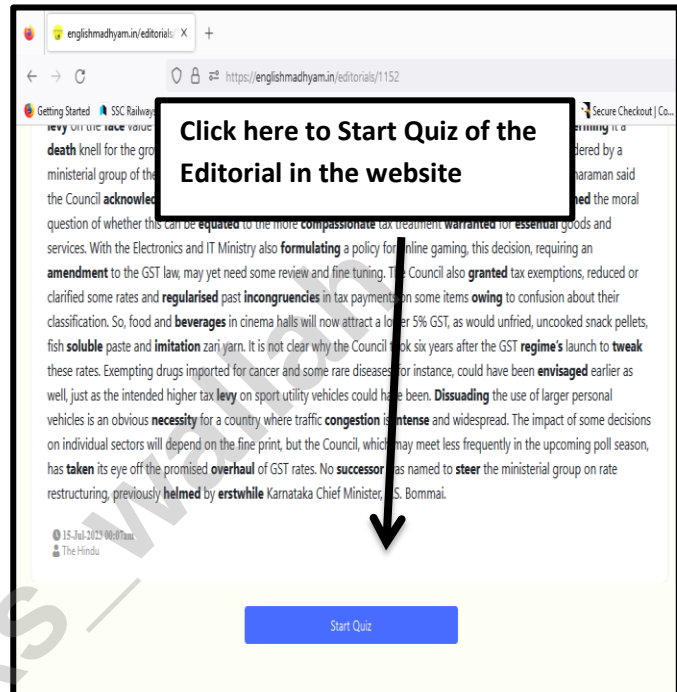
**Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.**



## Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



Click here to Start Quiz in the App



Click here to Start Quiz of the Editorial in the website

[Click here to download App](#)

[Click here to visit website](#)

